

Higher Education Union Confidential Brief

Day 4 Session 4 | Plenary B | Union team

Fictional training exercise. All institutions, disputes, mandates and figures are invented for learning.

Read only this handout and your sector's shared facts. Keep this brief within your assigned team.

A second item, not in your mandate: A group of members has asked you to raise the continuous-service requirement in the promotion criteria, which does not credit a career break. It costs the institution nothing in this financial year. It is not in your mandate and you are not obliged to table it.

Do not read: the separate employer-side download.

Your mandate: Obtain written acknowledgement that the arrears are a contractual entitlement, not a discretionary payment, and a payment schedule of no more than three instalments.

Your walk-away: You may not accept an outcome that treats the arrears as negotiable in principle. Timing is negotiable; entitlement is not.

What you know that they may not: Two comparable institutions cleared equivalent arrears within eighteen months. You have the figures for one of them and can cite it.

Your pressure: Members are asking why the union has not escalated. Some are considering individual legal claims, which would fragment your position and cost more overall.

What you could accept: Three instalments over two financial years. Interest waived in exchange for a firm schedule. A joint monitoring mechanism instead of immediate full payment.

What you cannot accept: Any formulation describing the arrears as subject to available funds without a backstop date.

Quietly: You recognize the institution's constraint is real. Your concern is that a vague commitment will slip again, as it did before. A credible monitoring mechanism may be worth more to you than a faster schedule - but do not concede that early.